

Auto Backup 2.2

Automate your backup and restore

Auto Backup (AB) is yet another tool to create backups—the alternate location could be a separate partition or physical drive, a network drive, or an FTP location. Both the backup as well as restore operations can be performed on individual files or folders, or even entire drives.

AB's unique feature is that it can create self-restoring archives.



Just double-clicking an executable file starts off the restore process. The software has all the standard features such as scheduling, compression, and security. There are three compression modes—Fastest, Middle and Maximum. When it comes to security, there's integrated 256-bit encryption, plus optional user-provided password encryption. This is to be compared with WinBackup's optional 128 bit AES encryption, optional 256 bit encryption, or optional password protection.

AB has a multi-threaded system, so that backup and restore can be executed simultaneously. The software loses out, however, in terms of performance—it is certainly not the best.

- + Easy-to-use interface, secure
- No support for backup on removable media

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Performance	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Features	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Ease of use	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Overall	■ ■ ■ ■ ■

Conclusion

Though AutoBackup took the top slot in the ease-of-use test, WinBackup came ahead of the others in both the features and the performance departments. Support for backup on removal media and security turned out to be the major factors in taking WinBackup to the top slot in the features test. WinBackup did have some good competition from Second Copy in performance, though.

Precautions

Data loss typically comes at the most unexpected of times, but following a few simple precautions can lead to a much better chance of recovering data. First of all, don't shut down or restart the machine. Next, don't install any additional software on the damaged drive. This also includes data recovery software. These should ideally be installed before data loss. If not, these software should be run from a CD-ROM or floppy drive. The most important thing to remember is that the lesser the activity in the system after data loss, the more are the chances of recovering the lost data.

CATEGORY	BACKUP SOFTWARE			
Product	LIUtilities WinBackup	Centered Systems Second Copy 2000	Peer Software Save-N-Sync	Han Soft AutoBackup
Ease of Use	17.25	17.25	16.5	18
Installation (Scale of 5)	4	4	4	4
Configuration (Scale of 5)	3.5	3.5	3.5	4
Interface (Scale of 5)	4	4	3.5	4
Updating (Scale of 5)	0	0	0	0
Features	27	18	9	24
Backup on removable media	✓	✗	✗	✗
Backup on network drive	✓	✓	✓	✓
Output single file	✓	✓	✗	✓
Drive-wise	✗	✗	✗	✗
Partition-wise	✓	✓	✓	✓
Folder-wise	✓	✓	✓	✓
Restore to alternate location	✓	✗	✗	✓
Security	✓	✗	✗	✓
Compression	✓	✓	✗	✓
Scheduling	✓	✓	✗	✓
Performance	32.26	31.50	21.05	22.35
Backup Time (seconds)	124	127	190	179
Total	76.51	66.75	46.55	64.35
Web site	www.liutilities.com	www.centered.com	www.peer software.com	www.han-soft.com

RECOVERY SOFTWARE

In this category, we tested three popular data recovery software: OnTrack EasyRecovery Professional 6.03, R-Studio FAT 2.0 and, Stellar Phoenix 2.0. All of these are primarily meant for recovering data from crashed or corrupted hard disks.

Ontrack EasyRecovery Professional 6.03

Just a little off track

The first thing that we noticed while testing Ontrack's EasyRecovery Professional 6.03, was its eye-catching and user-friendly interface. It's well laid out, with all the important function buttons for the recovery functions conveniently placed on one side for easy browsing. It also sports a cool green XP look.

Of the three software tested, EasyRecovery has the most features. It provides a number of diagnostic tools, which are useful for checking the physical status of the drive and analysing the integrity of the file structure on the partitions. For example, the size manager displays a horizontal bar graph for each folder and file to give a more visual insight into the utilisation of the space on the hard drive. Files can also be tagged to display files of a particular size in a different colour. Another useful feature is the specific recovery of data from corrupted Office documents and Zip archives. This is very handy, especially after a power failure, to recover any unsaved data. We got a good opportunity to

